



CLIMATE FUTURES · IMMERSIVE MEDIA

SALISH SEA DREAMING

We are the Salish Sea, dreaming itself awake.

An immersive climate installation, and a process of listening to a living sea.

A living bioregion uses technology to perceive itself. Visitors enter a field of relations, not a message, and many leave moved, and with a local way to stay in relationship with their own watershed.

GENERATED LIVE

Species-specific AI models and real-time diffusion, driven by live ecological data.
The sea is never the same twice.

CO-DREAMING

The work holds aspiration and ecological grief together, and invites visitors to add their own dream to a living archive.

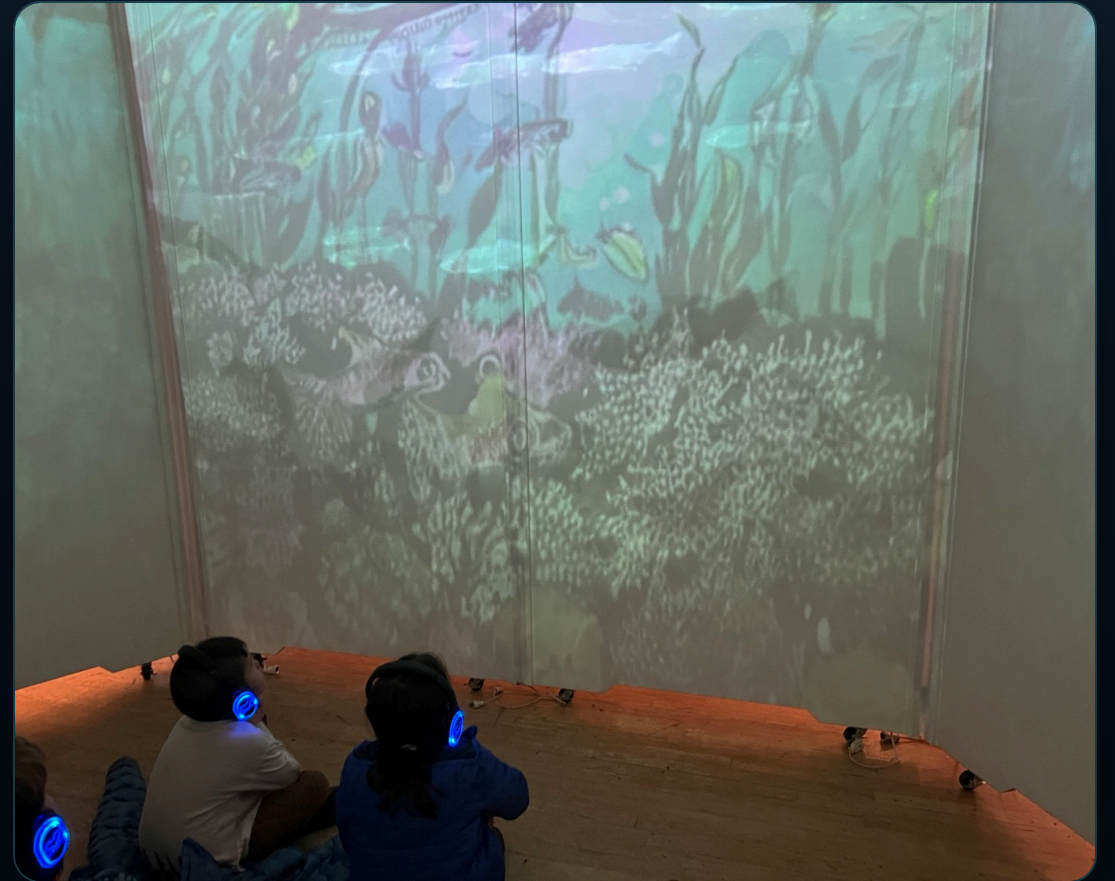
PROVEN IN 2026

Shown publicly twice this year and built to travel: re-deployed to a new venue in under four weeks.

Witnessing is rewarded.

A visitor steps into a darkened, ceremonial space, closer to a meditation room than a screen. Marine life moves across a large projection in a living watercolor language, grounded in live ecological data: tide, lunar phase, and river discharge.

The work rewards witnessing rather than input: a visitor becomes a witness to the sea, not a consumer of it, a counter to the attention economy. Where the venue allows, visitors [co-dream](#), offering a few words for the sea that join a live, semantically clustered, consent-governed archive of everyone's dreams.



The herring, rendered as sound

The story is the Salish Sea, told through its keystone: the Pacific herring. Forage fish are the base of a climate-regulating food web, the cascade that feeds salmon, that feeds orca, that feeds the forest through carcass nutrients, that sequesters carbon.

Herring are **worth more swimming than landed**. Markets cannot see that value; a quota system sees only the fish in the net.

Composer Matt Robertson translated seventy-five years of herring catch and spawn-collapse records into an evolving musical score: the history of the herring, rendered as sound.

The silence at the end is not the end. It is where the dreaming begins.



PROVEN, AND BUILT TO TRAVEL

2

public shows in 2026

3 wks

unattended April run

8h+

continuous visitor
day

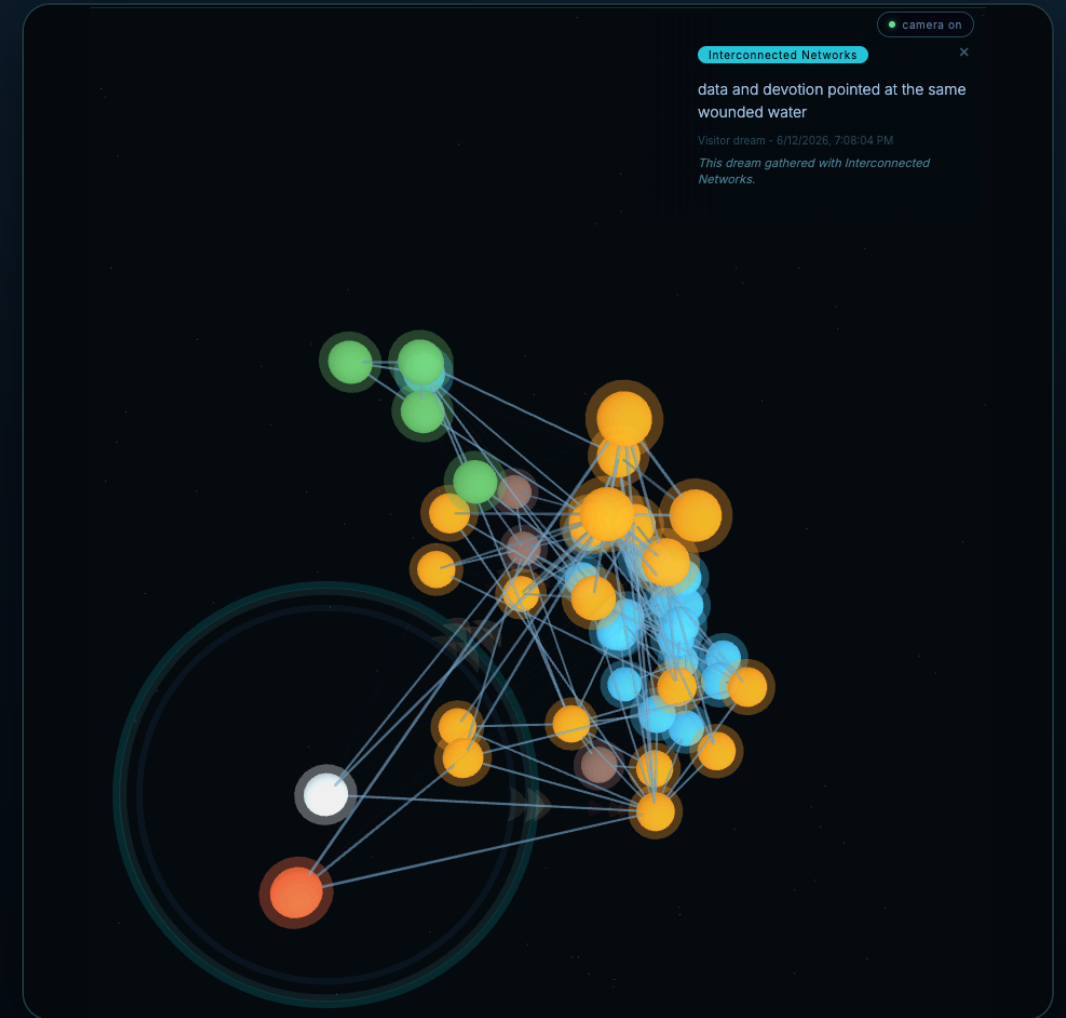
- **April 2026, Mahon Hall, Salt Spring Island** (Digital Ecologies). A three-week installation that ran largely unattended, with automatic recovery if a component failed.
- **May 2026, HR MacMillan Space Centre, Vancouver** (Indigenomics IMPACT). A re-deployed installation with live visitor co-dreaming.

Re-deployed to a new venue in under four weeks. That is what makes a multi-stop community tour low-risk.



Technology as perception, not extraction.

- A bioregional knowledge graph links people, concepts, ecosystems, and the threads between them.
- Gesture sensing runs **entirely in the browser**: no video or biometric data ever leaves the visitor's device. Only the words a visitor chooses to offer are kept, and only with consent.
- Coast Salish visual grammar is authored by the artist under a per-output consent protocol. It is never AI-generated.
- Indigenous knowledge stays with the communities who hold it. The open toolkit shares only technical scaffolding.



Not one show on tour. A method for each place to dream itself awake, co-created with local artists and local data.

- At each stop, co-create a place-specific work with local artists and that watershed's own ecological data.
- Harden the shared technical scaffolding (engine, data-to-sound, dome and large-format pipeline) so each place comes up quickly.
- Tour the US Salish Sea landscape groups, extending across the border to BC.
- An in-kind demonstration at the Turtle Island Bioregional Congress (September 2026).
- Release an open-source technical toolkit so other bioregions can build their own.

What we hope for

- 8 to 10 community installs; 2,000+ visitors.
- Paid local-artist and local-data co-creation at every stop.
- A real, local pathway into restoration offered at each stop, with uptake reported rather than promised.
- The consent-governed dream archive as the living record of each place.
- At least one other bioregion takes up the open toolkit.

THE NETWORK THAT DELIVERS

This is a standing bioregional network, not a cold launch.

Distribution runs through [Regenerate Cascadia](#) and the [Department of Bioregion](#), our US 501(c)(3) fiscal partner, and its Landscape Hub Cultivator network of watershed groups across Cascadia.

With the [Indigenomics Institute](#) (curatorial framing and sovereign compute), the [HR MacMillan Space Centre](#), and [MOVE37XR](#) anchoring production.

PROOF: IT HAS TOURED BEFORE

The 2023 Bioregional Activation Tour reached **14 communities in 30 days**, organized with 80+ people on both sides of the border, reaching **1,000+ people on under \$80,000**. Many of those organizers now run the landscape groups that will host this tour.

TEAM

Artists, technologists, and a bioregional movement.

Pravin Pillay · MOVE37XR · Creative Director, immersive production

Carol Anne Hilton · Indigenomics Institute · framework + sovereign compute

Eve Marengi · ecological-data sonification

Brandon Letsinger · Department of Bioregion · fiscal sponsor + tour

Darren Zal · Technical lead, bioregional knowledge graph (KOI)

Coast Salish cultural co-author · per-output consent protocol

Natalia Lebedinskaia · curatorial framing, proposal + budget

Matt Robertson · Austin Harry (InDigital) · data-poetic score + interaction design

With contributions from Moonfish Media (underwater cinematography), David Denning (bioregional photography), and SFU's MetaCreation Lab (generative-model guidance).

THE ASK

\$150,000

To bring Salish Sea Dreaming to Cascadia's communities: a method for each place to dream its own waters awake, and a door from feeling toward the restoration work already underway there.

Applicant: Department of Bioregion (US 501c3)

EIN 85-4402939

Experience it live: salishseadreaming.art